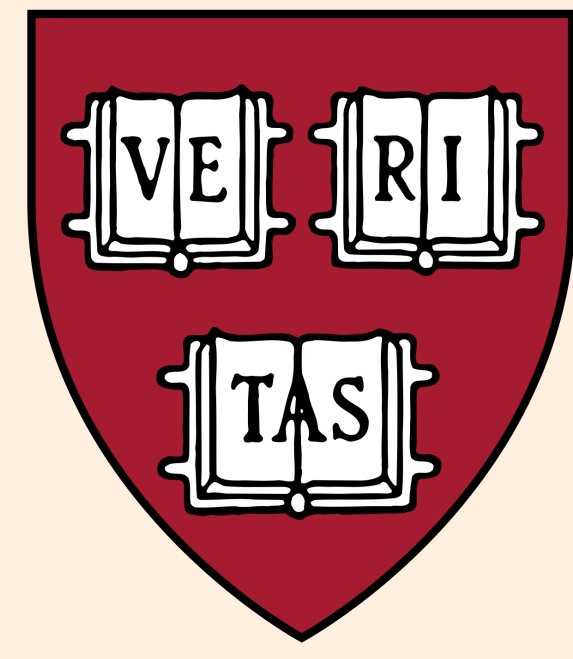




Movement and crossover asymmetries in the Seediq pivot

Yvette Yi-Chi Wu (Harvard University)

NELS 55 • Yale University • 17-18 October 2024

the Austronesian debate

- are voice systems **argument structure** or **information structure** alternations?
- are pivot arguments **subjects** or **topics**?
... or both/neither!

Austronesian voice systems:

- voice morphology**: morphological alternation on verb reflects which argument is the “pivot”
- pivot**: each clause has a morphologically or structurally privileged pivot argument
- extraction restriction**: pivot is sole argument that can be A'-extracted (e.g. relativization)

definite / specific requirement

- observation: pivots are **definite or specific** (Himmelman 1997, Aldridge 2004, Paul et al. 2015)
 - previous accounts highlight the asymmetry between pivot and non-pivot arguments
- d⟨m⟩ayo **kn-kingal laqi m-uuyas** [ka **kingal p-tgesa**]
<AV>help RED-one child AV-study PIV one teacher
'A teacher is helping every student.' ($\exists > \forall$; $*\forall > \exists$)
 - dyag-un **kingal p-tgesa** [ka **kn-kingal laqi m-uuyas**]
help-PV one teacher PIV RED-one child AV-study
'A teacher is helping every student.' ($? \exists > \forall$; $\forall > \exists$)

- revised: pivots take widest scope in a clause!

A/A' properties of pivots

TABLE 1: subjecthood diagnostics

control	reflexives	imperatives
N/A	✗	✗

TABLE 2: topichood diagnostics

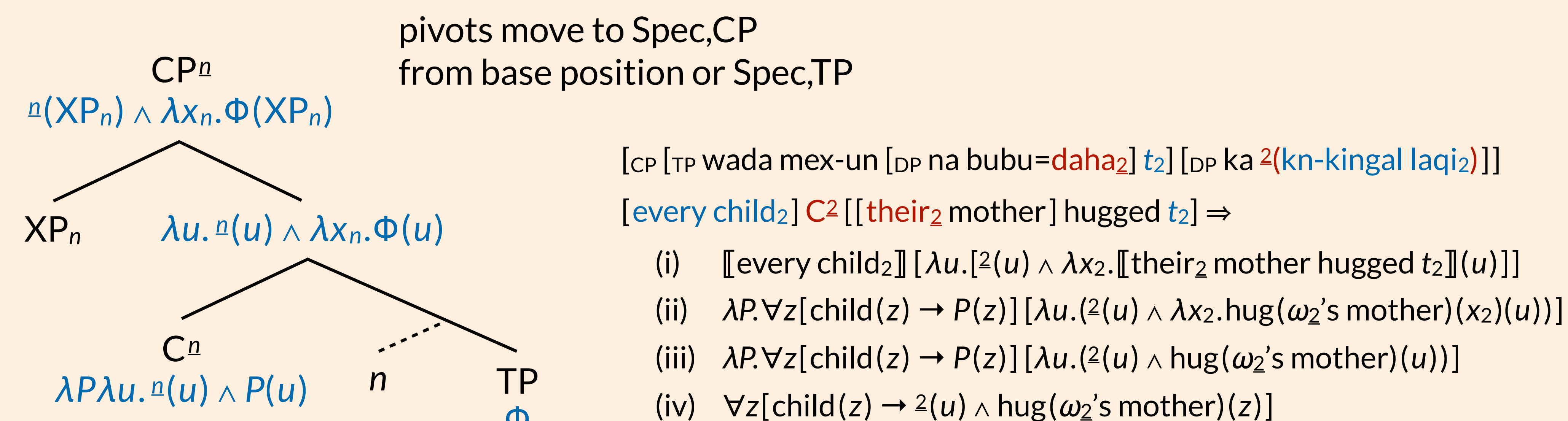
reconstruction	WCO	SCO
✓	✗	✓

- cf. Chen (2017), Katochoritis & Lohninger (2023), a.o.

key takeaways: 1) Seediq pivot movement exhibits crossover asymmetries indicative of topicalization; 2) topicalization patterns with A-movement in the creation of new binding relations

a **dynamic semantic** approach to crossover (Chierchia 2020, 2024):

- “bimodal” binding** (cf. operators μ and β in Buring 2004):
 - traces are **static variables** x_n bound by λ_n abstraction operator
 - pronouns are **dynamic variables** ω_n bindable across conjuncts of $\lambda()$ operator
- dedicated syntactic positions introduce **discourse referents (DRs)** via $\lambda()$
via predicates: 1) **topics (C)**, 2) **subjects (T)**, 3) thematic positions (AG, TH)



- a. #wada m-emux **kn~kingal laqi**₂ [ka **bubu=daha**₂]
PST AV-hug RED~one child PIV mother=3PL.GEN
'Their₂ mother hugged every child₂.' WCO attested
b. wada mex-un **bubu=daha**₂ [ka **kn~kingal laqi**₂]
PST hug-PV mother=3PL.GEN PIV RED~one child WCO obviated
- a. #wada m-angal hndayu na **kn~kingal seediq**₃ [ka **heya**₃ / **dheya**₃]
PST AV-take lunchbox GEN RED~one person PIV 3SG 3PL
'They₃ took every person's₂ lunchbox.' SCO attested
b. #wada ngal-un na **heya**₃ / **dheya**₃ [ka hndayu na **kn~kingal seediq**₃]
PST take-PV GEN 3SG 3PL PIV lunchbox GEN RED~one person SCO attested

implications: supports an A' analysis of Austronesian voice (Pearson 2005, Chen 2017)

- crossover asymmetries can be reduced to general binding principles
- A-movement + topicalization obviate WCO and violate SCO (McGinnis 2004, van Urk 2015)

crossover asymmetries

- a range of constructions that obviate **weak crossover (WCO)** but not **strong crossover (SCO)**
- Keine & Bhatt (2023) and Chierchia (2024):
English PP dislocation, Italian clitic left dislocation (CLLD), Hindi local scrambling
- incl. English A-movement and topicalization, cf. **weakest crossover** (Lasnik & Stowell 1991)

topic and focus related movement differ for the purposes of WCO (!!) → the notion of **A'-movement must be further decomposed**

	WCO obviated	WCO not obviated
English	PP dislocation	wh-movement and QR
Italian	clitic left disloc.	wh-movement and QR
Hindi	local scrambling	wh-in-situ and QR
Seediq	pivot movement	wh-in-situ and QR

- SCO is potentially reduced to a **minimality violation** during movement (Chierchia 2024)
- must look beyond English to languages with a greater range of topicalized constituents!

discourse constraints

- pivots serve the discourse function of **topics**:
 - familiar**
 - contrastive**
 - aboutness-shift**
- focus** constituents prohibited as pivots:
 - wh-phrase**
 - exhaustive**
 - weak quantifier**
- NOTE: focus elements must occur in-situ (i.e. in base position) or in predicate clefts instead

- wada bhang-un **ima** [ka **sisil**]? **wh-in-situ**
PST hear-PV who PIV sisil
'Who heard the sisil?'
- *wada m-bahang **sisil** [ka **ima**]? ***wh-pivot**
PST AV-hear sisil PIV who

SELECTED REFERENCES: Chen (2017) A reexamination of the Philippine-type voice system and its implications for Austronesian (...). • Chierchia (2020). Origins of weak crossover: when dynamic semantics meets event semantics. • Chierchia (2024). Movement and crossover in three languages. • Holmer (1996) A parametric grammar of Seediq. • Katochoritis & Lohninger (2024). Between topics and subjects: an A/A' typology of Austronesian pivots. • Keine & Bhatt (2023). Crossover asymmetries. • Lasnik & Stowell (1991). Weakest crossover. • van Urk (2015). A uniform syntax for phrasal movement: a case study of Dinka Bor.